

"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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[Filmed on location \(tour map\):](#)
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The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It’s a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.

After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.

Remember your first journey? I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word ‘Fiat’ itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience ‘**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**’ The discovery of the Fiat’s symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.

Let Scotomaville guide you on your ‘Personal Everest,’ empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

August 10, 2023

Dirty Gas

AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; **“The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.”** He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He’s demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

■ BACKGROUND - WWDWWD

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know **“Why We Do What We Do.”** and are committed to exploring the unknown... to ‘Know Thyself’. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. ⁽¹⁾ Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents ⁽²⁾. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We’re further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. ⁽³⁾ ⁽⁴⁾

We’re hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. ⁽⁵⁾ The adage to ‘Know Thyself’ is no longer a luxury. It’s become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. ⁽⁶⁾

■ METHODS - IMPARTATION

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:

Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal ‘journey with purpose’. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:

The program is more than just watching; it’s engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:

The Scotomaville journey doesn’t end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program’s licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING

By climbing a ‘Personal Everest’ and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with **“unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way”** ⁽⁹⁾ you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one’s physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one’s beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST

A ‘Personal Everest’ is a journey with a purpose. **“But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began...”**

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager ⁽¹⁰⁾

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

(1) <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/>

(2) <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/>

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) <https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/>

(5) <https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team>

(6) <https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked>

(7) <https://intelligentnetware.com>

(8) <https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations>

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

01

PAGE 24

SCOTOMA

FROM BIRTH OUR BIOLOGY BETRAYS OUR AWARENESS. SEEING THE WORLD AS IT REALLY IS REQUIRES A SHIFT IN OUR BELIEFS. THIS EXERSIZE WILL DO IT.

“WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER ABLE TO CHANGE A SITUATION, WE ARE CHALLENGED TO CHANGE OURSELVES.”
HOLOCAUST SURVIVOR VIKTOR FRANKL

02

PAGE 30

PATTERN RECOGNITION

OUR 20 WATT BRAIN IS WIRED TO CUT CORNERS AND JUMP TO CONCLUSIONS.

03

PAGE 38

MISPERCEPTION

THE SLEEVES ILLUSION DEMONSTRATES CHAPTERS 1 AND 2 AT THE SAME TIME. COMBINED WITH STORYTELLING IT IS A CONVINCING DISPLAY OF OUR VULNERABILITY.

04

PAGE 44

ABUNDANT SCARCITY

THE GLOBAL PANDEMIC EXPOSED MOST PEOPLE’S CORE BELIEFS INCLUDING PRICE GOUGING AND HORDING.

05

PAGE 52

ABUNDANT AWARENESS

AWARENESS COMES WITH A PENALTY. THE MORE YOU KNOW, THE MORE YOU KNOW WHAT YOU DON’T KNOW.

06

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HIEROGLYPHICS

STORYTELLING IS A SUPERPOWER. IT’S BEEN USED TO INDUCE FEAR AND COMPLIANCE FOR MILLENNIA. ITS EASY TO CREATE AN AMYGDALA HIJACKING.

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ONION PEELING

WDIDWID? WHY DO I DO WHAT I DO? MASTER THIS SKILL AND YOU’LL GET OUT OF SCOTOMAVILLE.

08

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FIXATION

WITH POWER COMES RESPONSIBILITY. LEARN TO THROTTLE YOUR ATTENTION AND FOCUS.

09

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EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY

CROSSING A GAPING CREVASSE IS EASIER THAN MASTERING AN EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY. TRUST ME ON THIS ONE.

10

PAGE 94

CREATING SILENCE

WHEN YOU CAN HEAR YOUR INNER VOICE THEN YOU CAN ESCAPE WALLED GARDENS.

11

PAGE 100

FEED YOUR GUT

YOU AND I ARE 90% MICROBE AND ONLY 10% HUMAN. THERE'S A COUP UNDERWAY. EXPOSE IT WITH A SIMPLE QUESTION - WHEN YOU LOOK DOWN - DO YOU SEE YOUR SHOES OR YOUR GUT?

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IT NEEDS WORK

WE MISS THE BEST OPPORTUNITIES FOR GROWTH BECAUSE OPPORTUNITY GOES AROUND LOOKING LIKE HARD WORK.

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STRENGTHS OFFENDER

WE WOUND OTHERS WITH OUR STRENGTHS - WHICH ARE OUR PERFECTED COPING MECHANISMS FOR EARLY WOUNDS.

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TRIANGULATION

NEVER GO-IT-ALONE. YOU NEED NO LESS THAN THREE FACETS TO HAVE CONFIDENCE AND GRIT TO SUMMIT YOUR PERSONAL EVEREST.

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CURVES

LIFE HAS CURVES. THEY ARE EVERYWHERE. LEARN TO RECOGNIZE AND LEVERAGE THEM FOR AWARENESS.

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SEGUE

A SMOOTH TRANSITION TO THE NEXT VOLUME WITH A SHOCKING EXAMPLE OF ONUS PROBANDI.

2.00

PAGE 160

PRELUDE

WE CAN LEARN BY OBSERVATION IN ORDER TO MIMIC. DANIEL JUMPS TO A CONCLUSION... SO YOU DON'T SO MUCH.

2.01

PAGE 170

PERSISTENCE

'KNOW THYSELF' IS NO LONGER A LUXURY - IT'S A FULL ON COMPETITION.

2.02

PAGE 180

PROCESS

LEARNING HOW TO LEARN WILL ACCELERATE SKILL AND LIFE MASTERY.



2.03

PAGE 192

EXPECTATIONS

UNMET EXPECTATIONS ARE WINDOWS TO OUR BELIEFS. YOU CAN GET A GRIP ON YOUR EMOTIONAL ROLLER COASTERS.

2.04

PAGE 202

PATIENCE

WAITING FOR OUTCOMES IS TOUGH. WHAT IF THE DELAY IS 'BREAD AND CIRCUSES'?

2.05

PAGE 214

PREPARATION

ACTING 'AS-IF', PIVOTING WITH MULTIPLE STRATEGIES, OVERCOMING CHALLENGES BY MENTAL PREPARATION.



2.06

PAGE 226

SETBACKS

DEVELOPING YOUR 'WHY' FOR MAINTAINING INDEPENDENCE BY TAKING PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY WILL SERVE YOU WELL.

2.07

PAGE 236

STRATEGY I

INCREMENTALLY BUILDING A STRONG STRATEGY WILL HELP, AS WILL PAYING ATTENTION TO LITTLE THINGS.

2.08

PAGE 248

STRATEGY II

DEVELOP A SOLID STRATEGY TO COPE, SHIFT, AND PIVOT WITH YOUR MISTAKES, ERRORS AND FAULTS.

2.09

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SUBTLETIES

LEARNING TO NOT JUST HEAR - BUT TO REALLY LISTEN IS A GREATLY UNDERVALUED SKILL.



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SQUALLS

HOW DO YOU HANDLE DECISION-MAKING DURING A DELUGE, DOWNPOUR OR A SQUALL? WDYDWYD?

2.11

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SATISFACTION

UNDERSTANDING OUR INNATE BIASES AND SHORTCUTS CAN LEAD US TO FIND SATISFACTION IN THE MIDST OF CHALLENGES.

2.12

PAGE 298

SELF-CARE

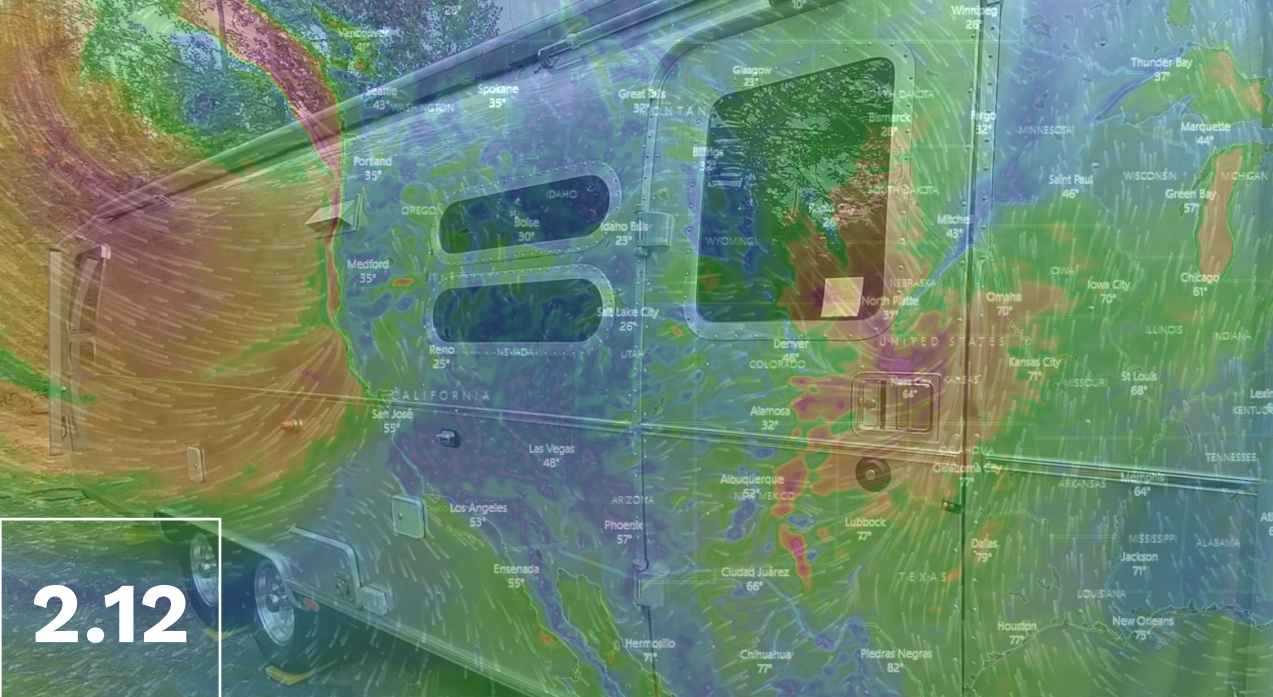
LIVING ‘THE DREAM’ COMES WITH SURPRISES. UNWRAP YOUR PSYCHOLOGY AND PHYSIOLOGY BY MIMICKING WELLNESS AND LONGEVITY.

2.13

PAGE 318

STORIES

WE BEGIN LIFE WITH THE STORY WE ARE HANDED. FORTUNATELY, THAT’S NOT THE END OF OUR TALE.



3.00

PAGE 336

QUICK START

EXPECTING OTHERS TO FOLLOW ISN'T FREEDOM OR WISE. PIVOTING AWAY FROM AN ERROR IS. THE REWARD IS IN GIVING YOUR FREEDOM TO OTHERS.

3.01

PAGE 342

FINDING WY

KNOWING HOW AND WHAT ARE IMPOTENT COMPARED TO KNOWING WHY.

3.02

PAGE 348

ROPED-UP

GOING IT ALONE IS CERTAIN CALAMITY, AS IS BEING ROPED-IN. DIFFERENTIATE.

3.03

PAGE 356

PACE & SEQUENCE

HOW MUCH, HOW OFTEN? THE PACE OF YOUR PRODUCTION SHOULD FOLLOW YOUR ACTUAL LEARNING BECASUE IT TAKES TIME TO GROW DENDRITES AND BELIEVE THE NEW YOU.

3.04

PAGE 364

MEASURING PROGRESS

WHAT'S THE MEASURE OF TRANSFORMATION AND SELF-MASTERY?

3.05

PAGE 372

INFLECTION

CHARACTER CHANGE HAPPENS ON A CURVE. AT SOME POINT THERE'S AN OBVIOUS PIVOT, AS WHEN THE OLD IS NO LONGER.

3.06

PAGE 390

MINYAN

A MENTAL ADVISORY BOARD FOR AI TO REFLECT, ASSESS, AND ADVISE. IMAGINE THE PEERS YOU WANT TO MIRROR AND GIFT THEM PURSUASIVE POWER.

3.07

PAGE 400

HEROES

EVERY HERO HAS A CHALLENGE. THE BEST OF US EXPRESS GENES AS A RESULT

3.08

PAGE 412

UNKNOWN

THERE'S A CURVE AHEAD. I'M CERTAIN OF THIS.

KEEPING YOUR NOSE UP - IN SPITE OF LOSS

PATIENCE IS ABOUT GAINING ALTITUDE WITH YOUR ATTITUDE WHILE WAITING

PATIENCE

2.04



FIRST CUSTOM FOIL-BOARD:

I have windsurfed for nearly four decades. This is the first new board I've bought since 1983!

"It took eight months
- and a missed season -
for me to pay for it.
Darn lockdown!"

You can see the wind is shutting off. I'm working to keep the foil's attitude up to prevent stalling. Of course, that is a metaphor, but this is the end of the season.

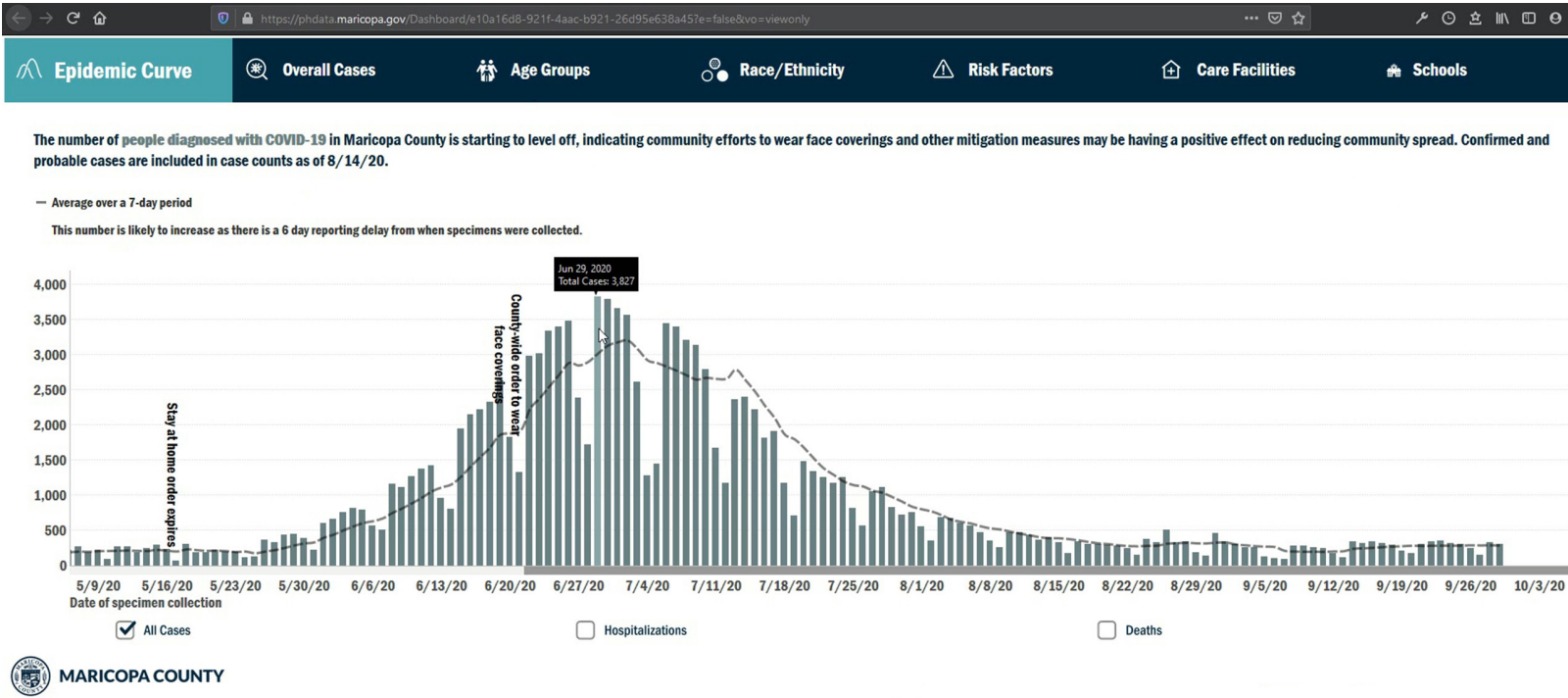
Overall, I'm starting to nail my jibes and be less of a klutz. Less of what's the word... the awkward partner. I'm less of that.

I'm satisfied with my progress. I'm finishing about three out of four of my jibes. I'm missing some because I'm stepping off the board or landing in the wrong place. It's a little too narrow. My new board's finished, but we're waiting for cash flow to pick it up. So patience on that. Yep, keep my nose up. Don't quit.

EVIDENCE YOU CAN FOLLOW

The purpose of my channel is to provide Onus Probandi - actual evidence of a Personal Everest so that you can follow - like the geese that fly in a chevron - for you to mimic and climb your Personal Everest.

Sometimes we get in a funk. Sometimes the season ends. You spend a week in the smoke, and then you get a week of no wind, and then you get a week of rain, and the season's over. Patience is not about waiting for things to happen. It's not about finding little tasks to keep you busy - like painting things, cooking, reorganizing, fixing your shoes, or even watch-



PATIENCE IS ABOUT LEVERAGING YOUR TIME TO GAIN INSIGHTS AND TO SHARPEN YOUR MIND SUBJECTIVELY.

ing epidemiological curves unfold for days, weeks, and months. Patience is about leveraging your time to gain insights and to sharpen your mind subjectively. That’s how I see it with my strengths and coping mechanisms defined as Achiever, Input, Learner, Belief, and Activator. Essentially those are a storytelling Vulcan mind-meld.

Pause for just a moment and think about your strengths - your coping mechanisms.

How do your strengths give you meaning? What do you do when they are stifled?

I decided to climb a Personal Everest - to learn and share by creating Scotomaville.

I’m wearing my mask at the event site, and I dare take it off. This is a horrible smoke.

With the past week of rain, I found myself really blah. I guess it was depression. I have never experienced that.

I BINGE-WATCHED MYSELF

I killed my gut with lectins from tomatoes and peppers. It’s been a couple of days fixing it with kimchi and chlorella. I had to use some of my tools to get my butt out of that crevasse. That one was horrible. Thankfully the mental tools work well for me.

One of the things I had to concede - allow myself to admit - is that for the first time in my life, I know what depression is - for at least a week. I

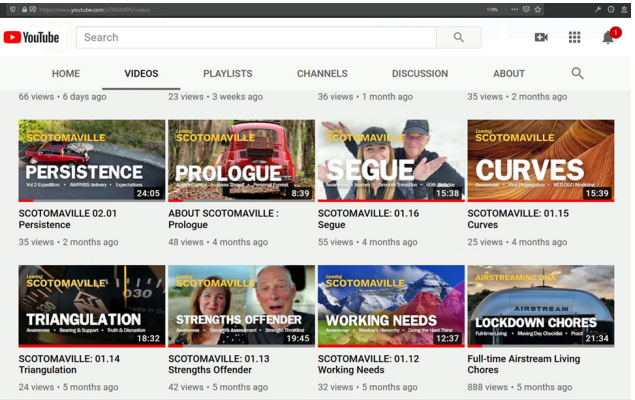


I SPENT A FEW DAYS IN BED, SICK AND DEPRESSED HAVING LOST MY COPING MECHANISM OF PLAYING WITH PEERS ON THE WATER.

unexpectedly lost my coping mechanism of being on the water. I then had to accept a premature end of the season. I was like... oh my gosh, I don’t know what to do with myself.

I ended up watching my episodes. So yeah, I went back and binge-watched this whole thing. I used my time off to review my progress.

Transparently I’ve spent a few days in a funk for the first time in my life because I realized that there wasn’t anything I could do about COVID or the smoke. That was mentally taxing. And then I realized I had never reviewed my own journey. So I watched half of my book last night and had a fantastic experience.



I BINGE-WATCHED ALL OF MY OWN EPISODES AND WAS SURPRISED THEY WERE DECENTLY ENTERTAINING AND DEFINITELY INSIGHTFUL.

You should do that too. It’s not bad, considering I didn’t know where I was going. I just set out to do something - as should you. I just stuck the camera out and started recording. I discovered that reliving my journey gave me a much broader perspective.

If you’re trying to get up an Everest and you get halfway in a cloud layer, and you can’t see the valley or the mountain top - ah, that can be horrible. Although you’re climbing, you won’t appreciate the journey. You’ll be on the mountain but without a decent perspective.

Because I have the book’s entirety as video episodes, I could watch my progress. I could watch tiny signals I give on fixation or when I am

triggered or pegged processing the next word. I could see those cues. I could see an overall improvement in just six months. That was enough to burn off the mental fog of not making good progress.

RELIVE YOUR JOURNEY

By mimicking me - shooting your journey, looking at your efforts in hindsight - you’ll be amazed. Take your Clifton Strengths Assessment, so you will know in advance where your fault-line and your footholds will be up your mountain. A perspective of making progress will be required at some point. It’s essential. Don’t just look at mine and think, oh yeah, I’ll just watch this. No, you need to mark YOUR pathway.



I'm encouraging you to record your journey. Maybe you don't want to put it on YouTube, but I'm assuring you that you'll want to watch your behavior change over time to realize that you are making progress.

If you're watching this to understand your partner, your child, or your friend, then watch their videos. Follow their journey too.

It's hard to see the value of your journey out of SCOTOMAVILLE while you are drowning in change, or while being patient, or stalled waiting for an event like graduation, or getting out of the military, or a wedding, or childbirth, or the next purchase, or getting better from an illness. Without accountability to someone else to show progress to, a lack of self-commitment and discipline will slow self-mas-

**“STORYTELLING IS EITHER A SUPERPOWER
OR KRYPTONITE – DEPENDING ON YOUR AIM.”**

tery. You'll gain a healthy perspective from the milestones of your journey. You'll value the evidence of your progress, and your subtle improvements will set you free.

STORYTELLING IS A SUPERPOWER

Storytelling is either a superpower or kryptonite. There are two points of view for this.

You can recognize storytelling as kryptonite when you're gamed or being handed a narrative. But, more importantly, when the story directing your life is omitting facts and evidence - then it's aimed at your head with the wrong outcome in mind. That's Kryptonite.

On the other side of the coin is the story you tell yourself. It determines how much effort you're going to make. Eighty-five percent of success is just straight-up luck via perseverance. When you practice long enough, you'll eventually be prepared for the opportunity when it arrives. That's because you'll have a superior mindset having done the work beforehand. But you'll never do the hard part beforehand unless you paint your future-self with an amazing story.

Therein is the superpower — the story you choose for yourself. The facts you align with determine your worldview and the effort you make. In the process, your scotomas - your blind spots - can be discovered and healed.

DANIEL YOU TALK WAY TOO MUCH

This week I discovered an old scotoma through a friend Alan Landis. I had hoarded a false belief for over a decade. In our conversation, Alan and I talked about storytelling as a superpower. I said, “Alan, you often make very persuasive points. One of them I remember well is that at

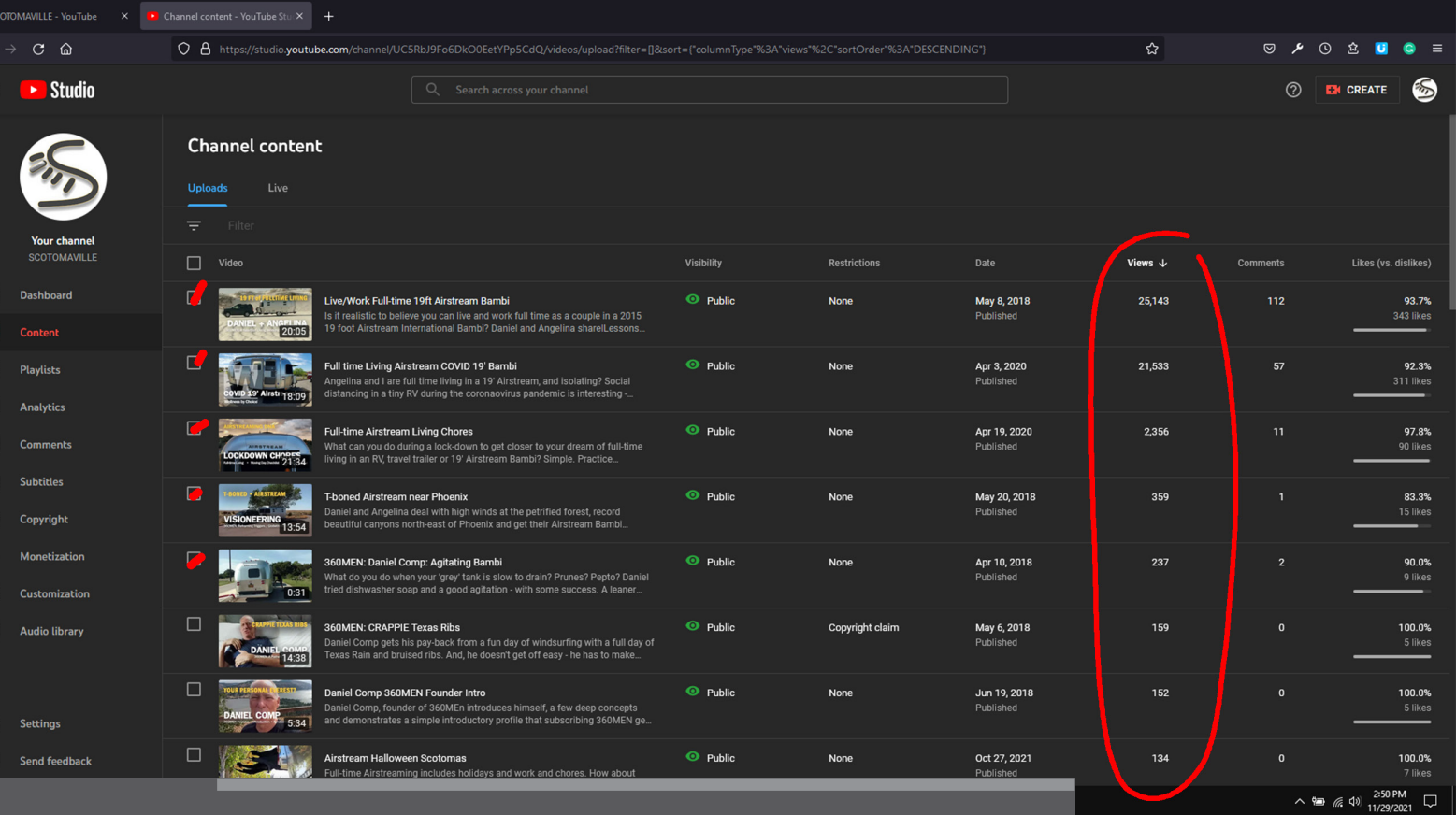
your dining room table, you said to me something like, “Daniel, you talk too much.” Alan said, “What? The point I was making was that it takes you a long time to get to your point.”

Wow, was I wrong? I completely misunderstood his point. Talk about a scotoma! We are 100% wrong 50% of the time!

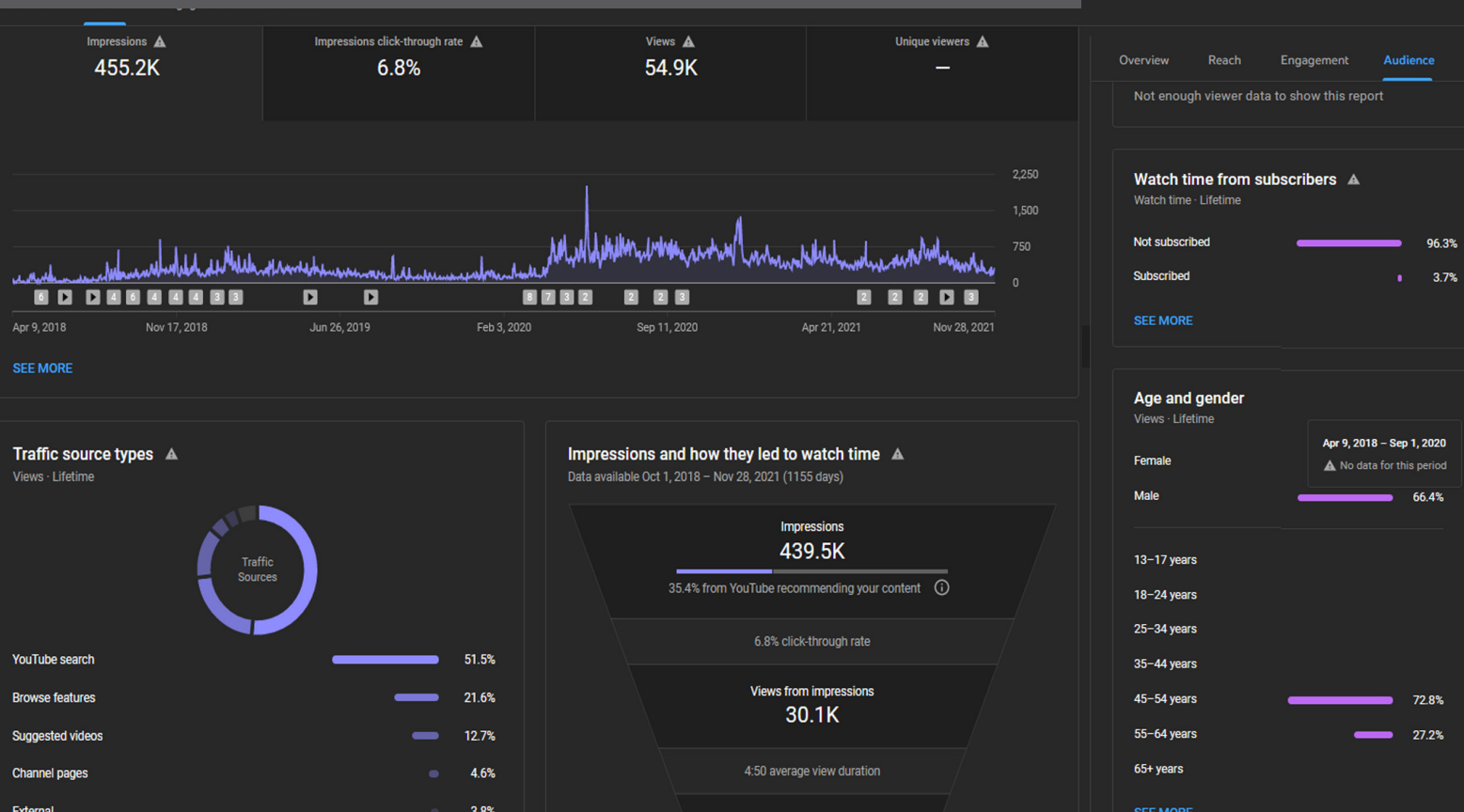
*I recall him saying, “you talk way too much,” as with Dale Carnegie pointing out that **our favorite subject is ourselves**. Alan meant that I'm very detailed with complex ideas, and it takes me a lot of words to make my point.*

Alan has mastered storytelling. He puts complex things into simple terms - something I'm far from mastering. Yeah, you get my point. I better stop talking. I appreciate Alan.





Note that of 54.9K views for the channel, 49.6K are for 5 of the 100 videos. That means 90% of the viewings are for the videos titles with 'Airstream'. 1/2 the viewers came from YouTube search and 1/3 from a YouTube sidebar recommendation.



OPPORTUNITY TO INFLUENCE

We are still chasing the acquisition of our Airstream - for the fifth time! Why?

It's for the YouTube Channel. Let me show you the actual numbers - the statistics - to base it on data. Look where I see is my opportunity to influence - to talk to you. You most likely came to my channel based on the Airstream title.

At left are the YouTube views of my channel and how long people watch each video. The top five videos constitute nearly all of my channel viewing time. 5% = 90%

AIRSTREAMING IS CLICK-BAIT

Our Airstream rental revealed a market I could address, and YouTube would promote it for profit. It seems I should make more videos about Airstreaming. 2/3 are men, and most are in the 45 to 54 age group. They're almost all coming from a YouTube search, and 80% are on a phone. But I don't have an Airstream!

Can you imagine the emotion of finally discovering a market and a topic of interest but losing access to an Airstream? I'm still waiting, maybe months and months and months, to get into our own Airstream. I know, patience!

After four prior failed attempts at financing the Airstream, we've learned a lot about persevering and patience. I bet some people believe our pursuit of an Airstream is about flaunting a luxury RV or lifestyle. (see Episode v02.12)

Nope. Scotoma. Our journey is about finding a way to connect with people. It's about building a bridge between us. It's my Personal Everest surrounded by failures and misunderstandings to share more important truths about AI and

the race of self-awareness.

In my mind, I need the Airstream as a tool to reach the audience with what I think is a more critical message. YouTube tells me I've found AN audience but is that MY audience?

With the Airstream I can communicate essential, and more profound, things not expected with the Airstream life - like the triggers that come from the surprise, shock, and unpreparedness for the twists and challenges. I can outmaneuver machine learning and settle Maslow's base with a mobile home and office.

BREAD & CIRCUSES

I learned something today because I did the hard work. I heard Attorney General William Barr say something unfamiliar. I didn't understand it. So rather than just let it go over my

AUTHOR NOTE: Imagine the tension of discovering a topic that YouTube promotes to an audience that actually watches the videos - but NOT having the Airstream to shoot further content with? We returned the Bambi at the end of Volume One, near the beginning of the pandemic, and had to live in a hostel while we figured out how to reboot and not lose the opportunity. Yeah that was crazy tough. The question is... are the viewers MY target audience? I'm not certain.

“it’s all about distracting people from anything that’s important and principled... that goes part and parcel with creating dependence.”

William Barr

head, I decided to look into his statement about ‘bread and circuses.’ Are you familiar?

William Barr: “*our constitution was meant for a discerning, informed virtuous people. You have to raise the question of whether we still have that in our country. We certainly have forces that are attempting to cultivate dependent people. And it’s the same old game. It’s bread and circuses.*”

What’s our bread and circuses today? It’s all distraction...

‘Bread and Circuses.’ That phrase piqued my interest because I didn’t know it. So I did, as I wrote in Volume One, the hard work: “don’t miss an opportunity to do the hard thing. Don’t just take a shortcut. Don’t leave it as ‘good enough’ and unfinished.”

I did the homework. It’s a very interesting phrase because it’s

prevalent in today’s society. ‘Bread and circuses’ refers to a poet-writer of the late Roman Republic before the Roman Empire. Politicians found the easiest way to rise to power was to pass into law things that were ‘bread’ - free food and welfare programs and guaranteed minimum income kind of things - coupled with ‘circuses’ (entertainment).

Think about the Internet and social media. In the Roman’s case, it was coliseums, but today it’s digital entertainment.

How do you rise to power and control the masses? In the Roman era, ‘bread and circuses’ was the strategy.

Look at the political strategies across the country: ‘give it away’ - ‘appease the masses.’ Don’t have people do the hard work. Instead, distract them with Bread & Circuses. It’s worth thinking about.

William Barr: “*it’s all about distracting people from anything that’s important and principled. That’s why so many people don’t pay attention. They’re distracted. They’re distracted by all the stimulation of their senses... That goes part and parcel with creating dependence.*”

SCENE CHANGE

The story we tell ourselves is really important because it gets us to do the hard thing like the research I did on Bread & Circuses. I added knowledge based on facts and not just narratives or emotional kryptonite. Later we’ll explore the neuro-chemical process that connects thoughts with feelings. For now, understand that imagining your ‘future-self’ makes it all easier.

THE STORY I TELL MYSELF

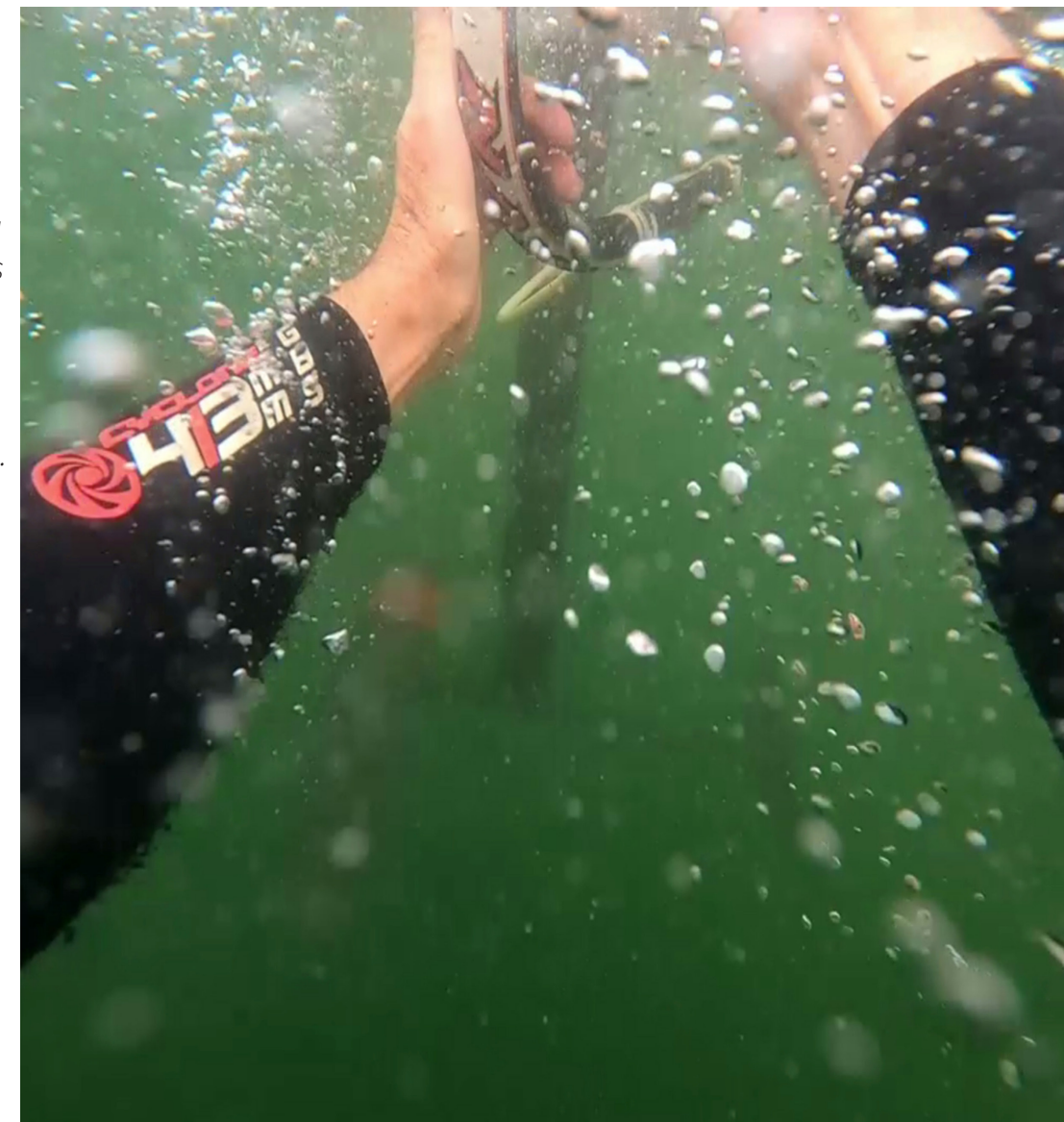
It turns out today I’m ill-prepared for the late-season weather. I don’t have the right gear to foil with others on the river. I have strong emotions about being left out, and I know where they come from. I remember false conclusions that I’m still working out. Patience.

Patience on the gear. I will finish paying for my new board based on my history of getting stuff. That’s what doing the hard thing can be about - persevering while waiting for the things and timing to converge.

I’m not giving up. I’m not settling for someone else’s kryptonite aimed at my life. I’m not settling for the life I was handed. I’m getting the heck out of SCOTOMAVILLE.

Thanks for watching this Episode. As you have seen, my story is not about Airstreaming. it’s about an inner expedition, so I appreciate your attention.

Upward!





WATCH



https://youtu.be/MXu-xr610_0

DISCUSS



Share a Bread & Circus insight with other readers, and the Author.

You've spent months in 'lock-down'. What portions of the stories you consumed were 'Bread and Circuses'? What relationship did the stories have with your emotions like anxiety, depression, withdrawal, etc...?

List thoughts, convictions and better outcomes.

EXTRA CREDIT



As a curious explorer and a scholar focused on self-mastery and the human condition, you may find this an intriguing example of how the pursuit of superficial

pleasures and reliance on external sources can lead to a loss of autonomy and eventual downfall, both on a personal level and in the broader context of a civilization.

The term "Bread and Circuses" (Panem et Circenses) originates from the Roman satirical poet Juvenal around the end of the 1st century and beginning of the 2nd century AD. Juvenal used the phrase to describe a method employed by the emperors to win the popular favor by providing cheap food and entertainment.

The Historical Context:

Emperor Augustus: The concept of "Bread and Circuses" began to emerge during the reign of Emperor Augustus (27 BC – 14 AD). He inaugurated the policy of providing free or heavily subsidized wheat to the Roman citizens along with public games, spectacles, and gladiatorial contests.

Continuation with Later Emperors: Following rulers continued and expanded these policies, creating an expectation among the Roman populace.

Political Purpose: By providing these amenities, the emperors managed to placate the masses and divert their attention from political issues, unemployment, and potential uprisings. It allowed the ruling elite to maintain control without needing to address underlying societal problems.

The Consequences:

Dependence on the State: Over time, these policies led to a population dependent on the government for sustenance and entertainment. The citizenry became less involved in civic matters and more focused on personal gratification.

Economic Strain: The increasing demands for public games and free grain put a substantial economic burden on the state. This, combined with other fiscal problems like corruption, weakened the Roman economy over time.

Moral Decay and Complacency: The obsession with pleasure and leisure contributed to a perceived decline in moral values and civic virtues.

The masses became complacent, and the societal fabric began to unravel.

Contribution to the Fall of the Empire: While "Bread and Circuses" was not the sole reason for the fall of the Western Roman Empire in 476 AD, it contributed to the overall decline. The weakening of civic engagement, the economic strains, military pressures, and internal corruption played a combined role in the collapse.

"Tell me about Marcus Aurelius's involvement"

Marcus Aurelius, the Stoic philosopher and Emperor of Rome from 161 to 180 AD, was indeed a significant figure during the period when the concept of "Bread and Circuses" was well-established.

Though he was a philosopher-emperor known for his wisdom and virtuous living, he was still a part of the Roman system that employed these tactics to appease the masses

Philosophical Stance: As a Stoic, Marcus Aurelius believed in self-discipline, wisdom, and civic duty. His personal writings, collected in "Meditations," reflect a desire for a more virtuous and thoughtful life. His philosophical ideals might have been at odds with the excessive and indulgent aspects of "Bread and Circuses."

Imperial Responsibilities: As Emperor, Marcus Aurelius would have had the responsibility to maintain peace and stability within the Empire. This might have necessitated his involvement in continuing the policies of free or subsidized grain and public entertainment, even if he personally might have found them extravagant or troubling.

Balancing Act: Marcus Aurelius's reign was marked by numerous military campaigns and internal struggles. The need to maintain control and public order might have required him to strike a balance between his philosophical beliefs and the practical needs of governance. He would have understood that suddenly abolishing such ingrained policies could lead to unrest.

Conclusion: Marcus Aurelius's reign, situated in a time when these practices were well-established, provides a compelling example of the tension between personal philosophy and the pragmatic demands of leadership. His attempts to reconcile these could be seen as reflective of the broader struggle to balance moral values with societal realities, a theme that resonates well with your focus on self-mastery, ethics, and virtues.





“Scotomaville” takes readers on an introspective journey into personal development. Through a seamless blend of philosophical dialogues, allegorical narratives, and psychological concepts, the book weaves an engaging exploration that appeals to both the mind and the heart. The author adeptly delves into themes such as perception, self-mastery, and the hero’s journey, showcasing a profound grasp of psychological processes and their influence on human behavior. **For those navigating the complexities of personal growth, the trilogy offers a transformative odyssey, illustrating that resilience and self-discovery are universal quests that resonate with individuals seeking to overcome inner challenges and doubts.**

This trilogy serves as **a reflection for military veterans and first responders**, echoing their sacrifices, camaraderie, and sense of purpose. The themes of adversity, seeking guidance, and embracing healing closely align with their experiences, providing a source of inspiration for those who have selflessly protected and served others.

For patriots and believers who hold their values dear, the trilogy presents character-driven narratives that mirror their dedication to higher principles. Exploring community, unity, and personal growth, the books align with their desire to positively contribute to society and reinforce the significance of collective well-being.

Fatherless individuals and young explorers identify with the trilogy’s portrayal of quests for identity and meaning. **The characters’ journeys from uncertainty to self-assuredness reflect the universal process of finding one’s place in the world, motivating young minds to navigate life’s puzzles with courage and determination.**

Moreover, **experts in fields from psychology and storytelling to stoic and biblical philosophy** will appreciate the trilogy’s profound concepts interwoven with relatable narratives. *The author’s mastery is evident in crafting a work that appeals to intellectual and emotional sensibilities alike.*

Throughout the trilogy, Daniel’s transformation serves as a relatable and inspiring narrative. His evolution from a curious seeker hindered by cognitive biases to a self-aware individual confronting inner doubts resonates deeply with readers.

In a world valuing personal growth, camaraderie, service, purpose, and self-discovery, **the Scotomaville Trilogy stands as proof of storytelling’s power to connect, inspire, and transform. Its pages offer lessons, insights, and reflections embracing the shared human experience, making it an essential read for individuals from all walks of life.** In conclusion, the trilogy’s rich philosophical discussions, relatable character arcs, and insightful exploration of cognitive biases contribute significantly to the fields of psychology and personal development.



Please express any correlation between my list of **strengths**, and a robust list of human **virtues**. Analyze the union of the two for shared characteristics and a deeper meaning.

Certainly! Let’s look at the intersection between the specific strengths from the Clifton StrengthsFinder that you provided (Achiever, Input, Learner, Activator, Belief) and a traditional list of virtues such as wisdom, courage, humanity, justice, temperance, and transcendence.

ACHIEVER

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Achievers have a constant drive for accomplishing tasks. This can correlate with the virtue of courage, which involves persistence and vitality, and justice, where hard work and fairness contribute to the overall good of the community.

INPUT

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom

Explanation: People with the Input strength have a craving to know more, collecting and archiving information. This resonates with wisdom, which is characterized by a pursuit of knowledge and insightful judgment.

LEARNER

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom, Humanity

Explanation: A constant desire to improve and learn aligns with the virtue of wisdom. It may also

align with humanity if the learning is directed towards understanding others and improving social bonds.

ACTIVATOR

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Activators are inclined to take action and want to make things happen. This aligns with courage, as it requires the boldness to initiate, and justice, where action may be directed towards equality and fairness.

BELIEF

Virtue Correlation: Transcendence, Justice

Explanation: The Belief strength is connected to core values and purpose. It aligns with transcendence, where there is a connection to something greater, and justice, where values often include fairness and equality.

Summary of Union (Intersection):

The union between these strengths and virtues reveals a **strong emphasis on wisdom** (through Input and Learner), **courage** (through Achiever and Activator), and **justice** (through Achiever, Activator, and Belief). The values of humanity and transcendence are also present but to a lesser extent.

This analysis suggests that a person with these strengths might be particularly well-suited for roles that require insightful judgment, bold action, and a strong sense of fairness and values. They may excel in leadership roles, educational fields, advocacy, or any area where wisdom, courage, and justice are paramount.

REVIEWS

Sarah Little-Turnbull



You know well of Sarah's talent. She designed the N-95 mask. She conceived of Halmark's tied ribbon bow, and CorningWare. She was a fabulous mentor.

"Daniel is a conceptual thinker who has the ability to implement his ideas with a spectrum of skills. His work represents a unique combination of abilities executed with reliability and great ingenuity. I recommend him very highly."

Graham Kerr



is known for his "Galloping Gourmet" television series and > 29 books. He's a charismatic facilitator of solutions for human indulgence.

"Daniel is continually creative. He has an excellent eye for light, form and texture and an ear for understanding his client's needs. Daniel is an unusual blend of Artist, Technician, Craftsman and Servant who can easily become a partner in your creative process."

Dean Rush



Dean has had distinguished military and business careers, and is the Author of Flying Free. "Daniel Comp is one of the most innovative people I have ever known. I've watched Daniel overcome great obstacles and stick to a vision of making a difference for people. He is personable and doesn't quit until the job is done. I highly recommend Daniel and his wife, Angelina."

2x Awarded by U.S. Small Business Administration, TV/Radio Host/Speaker, a fabulous business partner, wife and my best friend. "I've witnessed Daniel's evolution from a wounded, angry man into a mentally and emotionally mature gentleman. He leads other men with competence and confidence from his own transformation and experience."

Charlie Duke

"As an Astronaut (Apollo 16 Lunar Module Pilot & 10th man on the Moon). I was very familiar with powerful planes and rockets. I've learned to trust my life and business on great tools and competent people. Daniel and Angelina have put together an amazing system for small business that is technically advanced, yet doesn't take a rocket scientist to run it. I highly recommend their services - I didn't settle for anything less!"

Angelina Musik-Comp



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I'm deeply appreciative to those who have invested time, emotion and resources for me to devour. For the encouragement, mental support and feedback, thank you. You have been generous with interest, influence and guidance over decades. For those that journeyed before me, I am indebted to your bravery and demonstration of faith, perseverance and grit.

To all of you, I wish awareness and grace.

PARTICIPANTS:

Dean Rush



<https://deanrush.com>

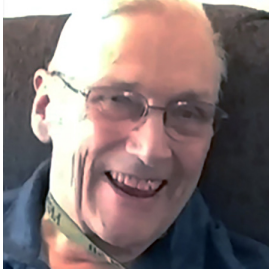


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Steven & Pam Krause
Kenny Rucker
Scott & Joyce Withrow
Scott & Jean Hamilton
Tim & Adelia Kleefeld
Erik Jurgensen
Alex Lauden
Doug Bell
Darius Taylor
Tim Hamilton
Ernest ‘Bud’ Pitt
Josh Cruse
Chris Poe
Robert ‘Stu’ Sturtevant

Garth Hardin



Merlin Berg



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David & Carissa
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Eva Sosa
Ilse McCants
Alan Landis
David Woodworth
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Dave & Soma Peterson
Bill & Kathy Sharman
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INFLUENCERS:

Alexis Gabriel Ainouz
Carlos Santana
Chris Hadfield
Dale Carnegie
David Deutsch
Derek Alexander Muller
Dr. Erik Berg
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Og Mandino
Peter Diamandis
Roman Balmakov
Robert Kane
Stephen Hawking
Tony Robbins
Tristan Harris
Wayne Dyer
Yuval Harari
Zig Ziggler



MASTER Forrest

To Angelina Musik-Comp:

I am deeply grateful for your stamina, patience, and support as my best friend and business partner. We have traveled the curves together in good cheer. You are amazingly resilient and a joyful character to explore with. I am grateful for your gift of HEALING matching my expression of UNDERSTANDING!

To you, the reader, and participant:

*When I imagined this project, I had a hunch the cost would be years of commitment - but not **five** years. What you might not imagine is that it took me far less time and angst to create the Wellness by Choice syndication, and the Scotomaville syndication of nearly twenty five thousand websites. And now we have AI.*

*I believe “**The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.**”. Fortunately AI still lacks subjective experiences, emotions, and self-reflective awareness - and thus our superpower of story-telling may yet be an error correcting trim-tab for super intelligent reasoning engines.*

Cheers to YOUR Greatest Expedition!

Daniel Comp
July 4th, 2023

CREDITS & REFERENCES

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